

Preston Mantel

Ph.D. Candidate, Department of Finance
Lindner College of Business, University of Cincinnati
mantelpl@mail.uc.edu · prestonmantel.com

Education

Ph.D. in Finance, University of Cincinnati	2022–Present
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Dissertation: *Essays on Market Microstructure Frictions and Retail Investors*
Committee: Mehmet Saglam (Chair)
GPA: 3.98/4.0

B.S. in Mechanical Engineering, Purdue University	2014–2018
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Minors: Computer Science, Global Engineering Studies
GPA: 3.7/4.0
Study Abroad: Universidad Carlos III de Madrid, Spain

Spring 2017

Research Interests

Market Microstructure, Retail Investor Protection, Regulation, Price Discovery, Market Quality

Honors and Awards

Research Excellence Award, Department of Finance, University of Cincinnati	2025
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Teaching Excellence Award, Department of Finance, University of Cincinnati	2025
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Working Papers

Mantel, Preston. “Taker Delays and Liquidity Provision in Prediction Markets.” Working Paper, May 2026.

- Studies how taker delays protect resting orders in short-duration prediction markets.
- Synchronizes Polymarket order books with Binance data and on-chain settlement records.
- Finds broader maker participation without a measurable loss in forecast accuracy.

Mantel, Preston. “When Lots Matter: The Impact of SEC Round Lot Modernization on Liquidity.” Working Paper, November 2025. Available at SSRN: <https://ssrn.com/abstract=5757242>

- Examines how SEC round lot modernization changes displayed and realized trading costs.
- Separates the visibility, crumbling-quote, and adverse-selection channels behind the reform.
- Documents a large gap between headline spread improvements and savings realized by investors.

Mantel, Preston and Mehmet Saglam. “Democratizing or Demoralizing: The Impact of Robinhood’s Order Types on Retail Trading Costs.” Working Paper, November 2025. Available at SSRN: <https://ssrn.com/abstract=4377192>

- Studies how Robinhood’s order-collaring policy affects retail execution costs.
- Combines regular-hours, after-hours, and SEC Rule 605 evidence.
- Identifies the broker incentives and investor costs created by the policy.

Mantel, Preston and Mehmet Saglam. “Discriminatory Market Making: Evidence from Institutional Trades.” Working Paper, July 2026.

- Tests whether market makers price institutional clients according to inferred informativeness.
- Finds no broad discrimination against informed clients across execution-quality measures.
- Documents bilateral learning from a market maker’s own profit-and-loss history with each client.

Mantel, Preston, Mehmet Saglam, and Tugkan Tuzun (Federal Reserve). “Actively Traded ETFs.” Working Paper, June 2025.

- Examines conflicts between managers and investors using trades from actively traded ETFs.
- Shows ETF trades predict abnormal volume and associates buy trades with positive one-day returns.
- Uses short-sale activity to study whether short sellers respond to ETF-driven mispricing.

Papers Under Review

“Democratizing or Demoralizing: The Impact of Robinhood’s Order Types on Retail Trading Costs”
Submitted to the *Journal of Financial Economics*

Conference Presentations

“Democratizing or Demoralizing: The Impact of Robinhood’s Order Types on Retail Trading Costs”

- Financial Management Association Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL 2023
- The Microstructure Exchange, Stockholm, Sweden 2023
- Southern Finance Association Annual Meeting 2024

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record, University of Cincinnati 2022–Present

- Financial Markets & Institutions (FIN 4053, 69 students) Fall 2023
Evaluation (instructor was excellent): Mean 7.11, Median 8
- Financial Modelling (FIN 4041, 49 students) Spring 2025
Evaluation (instructor was excellent): Mean 7.36, Median 8
- Financial Modelling (FIN 4041, 64 students) Summer 2025
Evaluation (instructor was excellent): Mean 7.61, Median 8

Graduate Assistant, University of Cincinnati 2022–2023

- Assisted with two finance courses

Service and Mentorship

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- Advisor, Bloomberg Trading Competition student team, University of Cincinnati

Relevant Coursework

Empirical and Theoretical Corporate Finance and Asset Pricing, Bayesian and Frequentist Econometrics, Advanced Microeconomics, Big Data Analytics, Game Theory, Statistical Modelling, Forecasting

Professional Experience

Founder & COO, Digital Paradise, Indianapolis, IN Aug. 2020–Aug. 2022

Founded marketing business; grew operations to over \$100K in yearly revenue with 2+ employees.

Technology Consulting Analyst, Deloitte, Chicago, IL Aug. 2019–Aug. 2020

Clients: Nestle and Intel.

Director of Operations, Watchtower Robotics, Boston, MA Jan. 2019–Jun. 2019

Managed 15 employees and \$175K in grant income.

Technical Skills

Programming: Python, R, SQL, C, Java, HTML/CSS, MATLAB

Software: JMP, Catia, Microsoft Office, Adobe Creative Suite, L^AT_EX